



STUDIO RIK VERSTEEG

Photography / Film / Design / Make-up

PROFILE

Creating bold visuals celebrating
Queerness and Identity!

Photography, Film, Make-up and Design.

CONTACT

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SKILLS

Photoshop
Indesign
Capture One
Dutch / English
Concept Development

Premiere Pro
Illustrator
English
Set Design
Styling
Make-up



EDUCATION

2009 - 2013

Bachelor of Design - Photography, Willem de Kooning, Rotterdam

2011 - 2012

Exchange Program - Photography, Academia di Belle Arti di Brera, Milan

2006 - 2009

AV-Production, Photography, Koning Willem 1 College, Den Bosch

2002 - 2006

Pre-vocational secondary education, Profile Economy, Waalwijk

WORK EXPERIENCE

2024 - NOW

Commission Member Art and Culture, gemeente Rotterdam

2024

Educational Assistant, X11 Academy, Utrecht

2018 - 2023

Educational Assistant, Fotovakschool, Rotterdam

2018

Customer Service, Kamer Express, Rotterdam

2014 - 2017

Manager Photography & Editing, Locals United, Amsterdam

2014 - 2015

First Assistant Photography, Ingmar Swalue, Rotterdam

2012 - NOW

First Assistant Photography, Anne-Claire de Breij, Amsterdam

2009 - 2010

Dynamic Activity, Teacher Photography

2008 - 2009

First Assistant Photography, Rene van der Hulst & Joost Govers, Tilburg

ARTIST STATEMENT

As a queer visual artist, I dive into self-expression and explore themes such as human rights, climate change, and our interconnectedness with nature, all through a queer lens and perspective. My journey as an artist is intertwined with my journey as a queer person, as art became a sanctuary where I found both solace and empowerment. Through my practice, I create a transformative space, both personal and collective, by creating art that lingers in the liminal space of reality and surrealism.

My work spans photography, film, makeup, and (costume) design, which allows me to redefine traditional artistic boundaries and cultivate a layered, immersive experience.

With a bold approach I aim to craft narratives that challenge societal norms, our search for authenticity, deconstruct patriarchy and the heteronormative gaze while fostering dialogue and understanding while inviting introspection.

A signature aspect of my art lies in my use of vivid contrasting colors, intricate concepts, and layered metaphors that speak to universal emotions while inviting viewers to connect with their own stories encouraging audiences to explore their perspectives on identity and belonging. My work is a celebration and an invitation: to understand, to empathize, and ultimately, to embrace authenticity in all its forms, foster equality and community, and dismantle stereotypes.

AWARDS AND SHORTLISTS

Morepixxx Fetish Photo Awards (2026)
Morepixxx Fetish Photo Award (2023)
De Kracht van Rotterdam Audience Award, Inholland Pulieksprijs (2019)
Foederer Talent Award/Eindhoven (2015)

SOLO EXHIBITIONS

"If you know, you know", Kargadoor Utrecht (2025)
"If you know, you know", Studio Rik Versteeg (2025)
"Queer Joy", Verkadefabriek (2025)
"Someday We'll Find Us, De Doelen Rotterdam (2023)
"Sensitive Obscurties", Roodkapje Rotterdam (2022)
"The Masquerade Ball" QUICK Gallery, Amsterdam, (2016 & 2017)
"Fashion Photography Prophets", Kunsthuis 18 Naaldwijk (2013)

GRANTS

CBK Rotterdam, Impuls en Verdieping (2024)
Gemeente Rotterdam (2022 & 2023)
Prins Bernhard Cultuur Fonds (2023)
Pictoright Steunfonds (2022)
Stichting Droom en Daad - Makersloket (2021)
Gemeente Rotterdam - Subsidie Kunst en Cultuur (2021)
Pictoright - Steunfonds (2020)

ART FAIRS

Affordable Art Fair Brussels (2018)
Affordable Art Fair Amsterdam (2017)
Art The Hague (2016 & 2017)
KunstRAI (2017)
For Real Art Fair (2017)
This Art Fair (2016)

GROUP EXHIBITIONS

Meet Photography Two, Maastricht (2025)
Superflirt Festival, Amsterdam (2025)
Photography Market, Amsterdam (2024)
Crafting Futures, Den Haag, (2024)
Fashionclash Festival, Tilburg, (2024)
"Ook van Jou", Rotterdam (2023)
Extraterrestrial, Ann Sun Gallery (2023)
Morepixx, Ramses Shaffy Huis, Amsterdam (2023)
Morepixx, Mannheim (2023)
Morepixx, Berlin (2023)
Groot Rotterdam Atelier Weekend, Rotterdam (2023)
Pulsion Mecaniques, Atelier Tramway, Switzerland (2022)
Queer Europ Photo Exhibition, Serbia (2022)
Photography Market, Amsterdam (2022)
Groot Rotterdams Atelier Weekend, Rotterdam (2022)
Pink Ukraine, Groningen (2021)
The Pottage Foundation (2021)
The Student Hotel Rotterdam, PICA PICA Zomerparade (2020)
Publieke Werken Rotterdam (2020)
Culture Supermarkt, Roodkapje Rotterdam, (2020)
De Kracht van Rotterdam, Kinki Kappers Rotterdam (2019)
Liquid by Motel Mozaïque, Rotterdam (2019)
Imaginary Band Land by Roodkapje, Rotterdam (2018)
The Performance Bar TakeOver | Hipsick Theatre, Rotterdam (2018)
InterTENTtion/TENT, Rotterdam (2017)
(Un)labeled Camp Pride/Rotterdam Pride (2016)
Most people are other people/Industriegebouw, Rotterdam (2016)
Roodkapje Radicals + ULtra/WORM, Rotterdam (2016)
Ambtenarenjargon/ Dutch Minstry of Finance/The Hague (2015)
Fotonale/Brugge (2014 & 2015)
Rotterdam International Art Fair (2014)
See me take over/NewYork (2014)
The Selfportrait/Amsterdam & Hilversum (2014)
Festival 39 Graden/Breda (2014)
Cultuurnacht/Breda (2014)
Barter/FoamLab Amsterdam (2013)
En Groupe/ Sint Maria's Gallery Rotterdam (2013)

PUBLISHED BOOKS

Mind Mirage, a Serenade to Hallucination, SNAP Collective (2023)

FILM SCREENINGS

Teaser "Puppies for Sale", "Amsterdam Fringe Festival" (2018).
Winterwolven V 'Shelters', Roodkapje Rotterdam(2016 & 2017)
Define Slow Fashion/ BLEND/BUREAUX (2016)
From Sculpture to Body/Ilona Putkaradze (2013)

GUEST LESSONS / WORKSHOPS

Kunsthal, Mask Workshop, (2022)
Fotovakschool Rotterdam / Lifestyle Photography (2021)
Fotovakschool Rotterdam / Lifestyle Photography (2020)
Fotovakschool Rotterdam / Portrait Photography (2020)
Fotovakschool Rotterdam / Portrait Photography (2019)
WDKA Rotterdam / Concept Development (2017)

PRINT PUBLICATIONS

Digifotopro, Interview (2025)
Uitagenda, Exhibition If you know you know (2025)
Haus Magazine (2024)
De Grote Nederlandse Kunstkalender (2024)
Intrada Magazine (2023)
Playboy (2022)
Hunter Mag, Artpop (2022)
WINQ Mag (2022)
Suspension, Muscalar Magazine (2022)
Nion Magazine, don't feed the kitty cat (2021)
De Grote Nederlandse Kunstkalender (2021)
Andc Magazine (2020)
Digifotopro, Mode & Glamour Interview, Nummer 5 (2019)
Linda . Meiden, Feminist Colofon, Sept-Oct (2019)
Hollandse Beelden Editie 14, De Kracht van Rotterdam (2019)
TransMagazine Cover (2017)
Campaign Wasteland (2016)
CHMPGN/Amsterdam (2015)
Rotterdamse Kunstkalender (2015)
Curated Newspaper/Bristol (2015)
De Etalage/FOTOfrafie Magazine (2015)
Campaign Blik & Bloos /Breda (2014)
De Witte Piet/Volkskrant (2013)
NEW/GUP (2013)
Als hij mij maar niet aanraakt/Gaykrant (2013)
Cover/Fashion Gun Magazine (2013)
Going Dutch/ Wylde Magazine (2013)
Photosynthesis/Gun L'Homme Magazine (2013)
Prophets/Uptempo Magazine (2013)
Beastiallity/Fashion Gun Magazine (2012).

ONLINE PUBLICATIONS

Porcnceptual, If you know you know (2025)
Kaltblut Magazine, Arcadia (2024)
Queer Art Hub, Interview (2024)
Digifotopro, Article Mind Mirage (2024)
Pornceptual, Suspension (2021)
Kalblut MAG, Suspension (2021)
Ahmad Joudex x Studio Rik Versteeg /Kalblut Mag (2020)
NRC Online / De Kracht van Rotterdam (2019)
Nos Online / Een blad vol LHBTQ+ (2019)
TransMag.nl/ De Kracht van Rotterdam (2019)
WINQ.nl/ De Kracht van Rotterdam (2019)
FotoMagazine APL 26 (2018)
Puppies for Sale Campagne Image, Rail TV & NS Onderweg (2018)
Djojo & Versteeg x The Boy Scouts (2017)
Djojo & Versteeg Ontwikkelen Pride Expositie/GayRotterdam (2017)
Discover TWOL24/Blend/Bureaux (2016)
Djojo & Versteeg/Landscape Art Review (2015)
The Surrealistic Work of Djojo & Versteeg/CITIZENMAG.com (2015)
Het beste van HP/De Tljd Expo 2014/HP DeTijd (2014)
Djojo & Versteeg the new iconic duo of fashion photography and art-direction/
Iconoclast Daily (2014)
Djojo & Versteeg en de mens als weerspiegeling van het universum/HP DeTijd (2014)

ART SALES

2025	
Milking I	Daniels
Masc for Masc II	Daniels
Dick(pic)	Badu
Scratched	Kaufmann
2023	
Manoj for Intrada	Diels
2022	
Suspension, IX, 1/5	Haywood
Headpiece Hermes Wings	Abend
2021	
Quarantaine "Golden Toiletteries", 1/5	Daniels
2020	
The Antagonist of Obstruction, 1/5	Neyndorff
BLM Donation Print1/20	Mulder
BLM Donation Print 2/20	Bont
The Fortress of Liquid Gold, 4/5	Bos
The Red Indulgence 1/5	Bos
The Ambiguous Bouque 3/5	Private
2018	
Puppies for Sale, 1/5	Borstlap
The Fortress of Liquid Gold, 4/5	Private
2017	
The Fortress of Liquid Gold, 2/5	Borisch-Pagel
The Fortress of Liquid Gold, 3/5	Luchthuis
The Ambiguous Bouquet, 2/5	Veenhuizen
The Fortress of Liquid Gold, 2/3	Vaart
The Fortress of Liquid Gold , 1/5	Bresser
The Ambiguous Bouquet, 1/5	Bresser
The Ambiguous Bouquet, 3/3,	Vlasblom
The Crystalline Delight, 1/3	Bos
The Ambiguous Bouquet, 2/3,	Heinstra
The Ambiguous Bouquet, 1/3,	Hamburg
2016	
Noa Beguile, Act I, 60x90cm, 1/5,	Luyx
The Fortress of Liquid Gold,100x150 ,1/3	Hilders